CHAPTER 1

NAVIGATING LEADERSHIP: FROM SCIENCE TO PRACTICE

Summary

This opening chapter introduces the importance of evidence-based leadership strategies in today's complex environment. By taking a scientific approach, it differentiates the book from superficial self-help guides. The authors summarise the book's structure and provide an overview of how to use it effectively. The chapter outlines how leadership is a learned skill and emphasizes the value of research in supporting leadership development. Additionally, it sets the stage for readers to begin navigating their leadership journey with a reflective exercise.

Chapter Outline

What Is Leadership – And What Makes It a Science?

From Science to Practice: Why This Is Not an 'Airport Book'

About This Book and the Authors

How to Use This Book

Getting Started: Your Leadership Development Journey

Personal Development Activities

To help energize you for this book and getting started on the adventure of your leadership journey, we invite you to start it with a purpose by entering your answers to the questions below. Perhaps you can also share your answers with a co-traveler on your leadership journey. This could be a trusted friend, colleague, or your mentor. Ask them for feedback:

Where do they see you on the journey? Where do they think you may be going, and how would they advise you to get there?

Questions:	Your answers:
• Traveling with a purpose: What made you want to become a leader? • Going back to the start: When did you first see yourself as a leader and how has this influenced you? • Destination planning: Where do you want to go as a leader? Are there places you would rather avoid? • Co-travelers on your journey: Who has influenced you as a leader? Who do you influence?	

Key Reading

Liu, Z., Venkatesh, S., Murphy, S.E. & Riggio, R. E. (2020). Leader development across the lifespan: A dynamic experiences-grounded approach. *The Leadership Quarterly,* 101382. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.leaqua.2020.101382

Further Reading

Lord, R. G., Gatti, P. & Chui, S. L. M. (2016). Social-Cognitive, Relational, and Identity-Based Approaches to Leadership. *Organizational Behavior and Human Decision Processes,* 136, 119-134. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.obhdp.2016.03.001